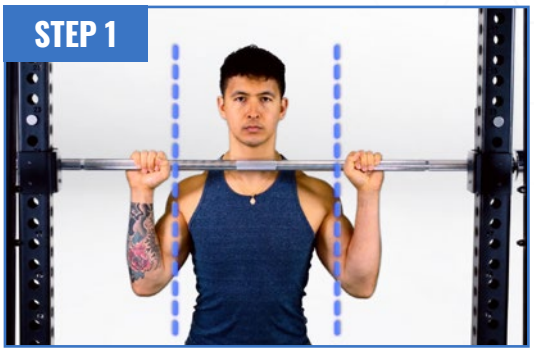
STANDING BARBELL OVERHEAD PRESS

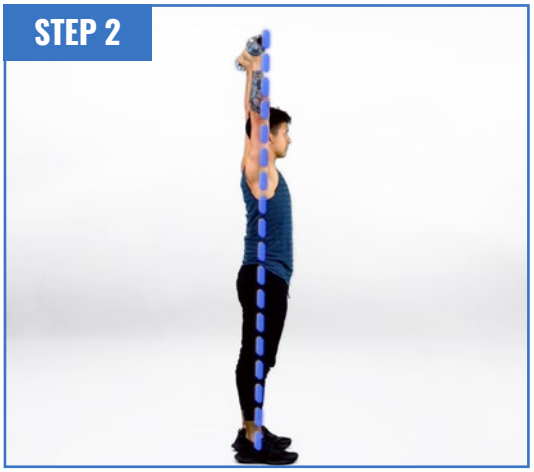
STEP 1: SETUP

Set up the bar in a rack such that it's at the level of your armpits. Get under the bar and grab it with a grip just outside shoulder-width apart. Tuck your elbows so that they align directly under the bar with your forearms vertical. Lift the bar up off the rack, take 3 steps back, and plant your feet about shoulder width apart with your toes slightly pointed outwards.



STEP 2

Squeeze your glutes, flex your quads, and brace your core. Take a deep breath in through your nose and then exhale as you press the bar straight up. As you do so, slightly tilt your chin back to avoid hitting it. Once the bar passes your head, you can tilt your head back forward back into its neutral position. Press until your arms are straight.



STEP 3

Inhale as you lower the bar by dropping your elbows into a roughly 45 degree angle in front of your body until the bar reaches the level of your upper chest. Pause here briefly, re-stabilize your glutes and core if needed, and then continue for your next rep.

ADDITIONAL TIPS

Avoid bending your knees and using leg drive to move the weight up. This is a different exercise. Instead, keep this a strict press by only using your upper body to press the weight up.